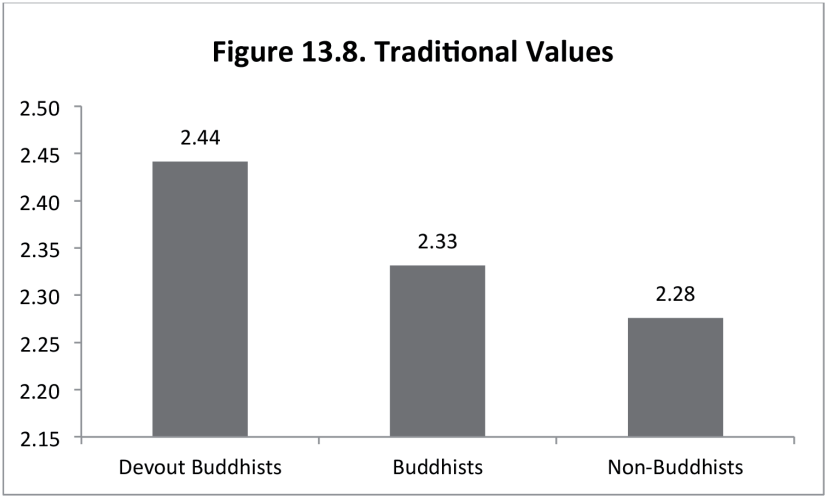
related to more traditional values. Devout Buddhists have more traditional attitudes compared to other Buddhists and citizens of other religions, as shown in Figure 13.8. To measure traditional values we combine a variety of questions looking at attitudes toward individualism, gender, and social relations. Higher composite scores (with four the highest) indicate higher levels of traditionalism. The findings show a strong relationship between religion and traditionalism. This is not unexpected, as more traditional values have long been seen to include conservative views of religion (see Norris and Inglehart 2009).



As was the case with ethnicity, religious divisions sharpen when citizens were asked about the treatment of religious communities by the government. Respondents were asked to agree or disagree with the following statement: "All citizens from different religious communities in Myanmar are treated equally by the government." Non-Buddhists expressed concerns, with only forty-four per cent perceiving equal treatment. This compared with nearly two-thirds of Buddhists (sixty-three per cent) and over two-thirds of devout Buddhists (seventy per cent) who agreed with the statement. Religious minorities also had less positive views of religious freedom, with only sixty-one per cent perceiving that religious freedom had improved in the current government, compared to seventy-seven per cent of Buddhists and eighty-two per cent of devout Buddhists. Buddhists perceived considerably more freedom to practice their faith.